

EMERGENCY GUIDE



CHOKING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Stay calm and gently restrain the dog. A panicked dog may bite.**
- 2 Open the mouth and look for a visible object.**
- 3 If you can see it clearly, sweep it out with a finger. Never push it deeper.**
- 4 Small dog: hold upside down and give firm back blows between the shoulder blades.**
- 5 Large dog: lift the hind legs (wheelbarrow) and give back blows.**
- 6 Still choking: firm abdominal thrusts just behind the ribcage.**
- 7 Get to a vet immediately, even once the object is out.**



POISONING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 **Do NOT induce vomiting unless a vet specifically tells you to.**
- 2 **Identify the substance: name, estimated amount, time of ingestion.**
- 3 **Key toxins: grapes/raisins, xylitol, chocolate, macadamias, rat bait, paracetamol, lilies.**
- 4 Call your vet or emergency animal hospital immediately. Bring the packaging.
- 5 Watch for vomiting, tremors, drooling, lethargy, seizures.
- 6 Never give milk, salt water or home remedies without vet instruction.
- 7 Keep the dog warm and calm. Get to an emergency vet without delay.



OVERHEATING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1** Move the dog to shade or air-conditioning immediately.
- 2** Do NOT use ice or ice-cold water. It can cause shock.
- 3** Offer small amounts of cool water.
- 4** Wet the coat with cool water, especially belly, paws and armpits.
- 5** Use a fan to speed up cooling.
- 6** Watch for heavy panting, drooling, bright red gums, collapse.
- 7** Get to a vet. Heatstroke can be fatal even after cooling.



SNAKE BITE

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1** Keep the dog as still and calm as possible. Movement spreads venom.
- 2** Do NOT wash the wound, apply a tourniquet, or try to suck out the venom.
- 3** Carry the dog if you can, and keep the bite below heart level.
- 4** Note the snake's appearance if safe. Never chase it.
- 5** Watch for weakness, drooling, dilated pupils, collapse.
- 6** Get to a vet or emergency hospital now. Antivenom is time-critical.



SPIDER BITE

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Keep the dog calm and still.**
- 2 Do NOT bandage tightly or apply a tourniquet.**
- 3 Identify the spider if safe. Redback and funnel-web are dangerous.**
- 4 Apply a cold compress to reduce swelling.**
- 5 Watch for muscle tremors, vomiting, weakness, difficulty breathing.**
- 6 Get to a vet immediately for funnel-web or redback bites.**



DROWNING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1** Get the dog out of the water safely. Mind your own safety first.
- 2** Small dog: hold upside down briefly to drain water. Large dog: lie on its side, head lower.
- 3** Check for breathing and a heartbeat.
- 4** Not breathing: close the mouth and give rescue breaths into the nose.
- 5** No heartbeat: begin CPR chest compressions.
- 6** Keep the dog warm and get to a vet. Secondary drowning can occur hours later.



TICKS

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Check the whole body. Head, ears, neck, and between the toes.**
- 2 Do NOT burn it or use chemicals.**
- 3 Use fine tweezers or a tick remover, gripping close to the skin.**
- 4 Pull straight out with steady pressure. Don't twist or squeeze the body.**
- 5 Save the tick in a container for identification.**
- 6 Watch for wobbliness, weakness, vomiting or breathing changes (paralysis tick).**
- 7 See a vet urgently if any paralysis-tick signs appear.**



SEIZURES

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Stay calm and note the time. Most seizures last under 2 minutes.**
- 2 Do NOT put your hands near the mouth. You may be bitten.**
- 3 Do NOT restrain the dog. Let the seizure run its course.**
- 4 Clear the area of hard or sharp objects.**
- 5 Dim the lights and keep noise down.**
- 6 A seizure over 5 minutes, or repeated seizures, is an emergency.**
- 7 Keep the dog cool afterwards and call your vet.**



DOG FIGHT

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 **STAY CALM.** Being loud, panicked or hysterical does not help. A calm, firm response does.
- 2 **Each owner grabs their OWN dog's hind legs and pulls it back.** The single most important move, and the one people never do.
- 3 **Do NOT grab collars or reach between the dogs.** You will be bitten.
- 4 Small dog? Pick them up, but never by the lead or collar. Too many people choke their own dog in a panic.
- 5 No hands free? Make a loud noise, use a hose, or throw water to break their focus.
- 6 Use a barrier like a board, bag or chair to separate them.
- 7 Once apart, keep the dogs separated and leashed.
- 8 Check both dogs for puncture wounds. They hide under fur.
- 9 See a vet. Bite wounds often become infected.



BLEEDING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1** Apply firm, direct pressure with a clean cloth or gauze.
- 2** Hold pressure for at least 3-5 minutes without lifting to check.
- 3** If blood soaks through, add more cloth on top. Don't remove the first.
- 4** Raise the wound above heart level if possible.
- 5** For a limb, a snug (not tourniquet-tight) bandage can help.
- 6** Watch for pale gums, weakness, rapid breathing. Signs of shock.
- 7** Get to a vet for anything deep, spurting, or that won't stop.

IMPORTANT

This guide is general information only. It is not veterinary or medical advice, and it is not a substitute for professional care from a qualified vet.

In an emergency, contact your vet or the nearest emergency animal hospital immediately. When in doubt, always call a vet.

Every dog and every situation is different. The steps here may not suit your dog's specific circumstances, and following them is at your own risk.

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